PECUNA FACTOREM · WHITEBOARD WEDNESDAYS · RESEARCH

Performance Poster

Character limits, optimal lengths and hashtag research for YouTube, LinkedIn and Instagram, plus the blueprint for a skill that turns a video brief into finished posts for all three.

YOUTUBE LINKEDIN INSTAGRAM

Researched 20 October 2026 · UK English
Prepared for Taylor Cunningham, Pecuna Factorem
Status: research complete. The Performance Poster skill is not yet built; Section 6 is its blueprint. Thumbnail Tracker is unchanged. This report lifts its proven parts; it doesn't edit them.

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How to read this report

- **Source types.** Every hard limit is **official** (the platform's own help pages, developer docs or named staff on record), **third-party** (vendor studies, trade press) or **observed** (our own data, or a figure vendors report without a published method).
- **Confidence.** Every finding has a confidence tag: `HIGH` `MEDIUM` `LOW`. Sample sizes (n) are given wherever a study publishes them.
- **Correlation, not proof.** Almost every large dataset here is a tool vendor's observational data. It shows what goes with good results, not what causes them.
- **Kept separate.** Research findings are kept apart from Pecuna's **house rules** (e.g. the WhatsApp CTA on line 1). Where the research contradicts a house rule, we say so and recommend a change. Taylor decides.
- **Access limits.** Instagram and LinkedIn block logged-out access, and YouTube blocked bulk re-fetching on the day. So creator-level Instagram and LinkedIn samples are tiny or empty. Section 7 lists every gap and how to close it.

01 · SUMMARY

The numbers on one page

YOUTUBE DESCRIPTION

800–2,000

characters, never padded · hard limit 5,000 bytes

3 hashtags (only 3 are ever shown)

LINKEDIN POST

900–1,500

characters for reach · 1,500–2,500 for comments · max 3,000

1–2 hashtags (3 max)

INSTAGRAM CAPTION

125–500

characters on Reels · under 30 words on carousels · max 2,200

3–5 hashtags (hard cap 5)

Platform	Hard limit	Visible before the fold	Optimal length	Hashtags	Confidence
YouTube title	100 characters (official)	~60–70 desktop, ~40–60 mobile (third-party)	Main keyword in the first ~50 characters	Allowed in the title; not used by the research creators	HIGH limit · LOW truncation
YouTube description	5,000 characters (Help) / 5,000 bytes (API). Budget in bytes.	"The first few lines" (official); ~157 desktop, ~100–150 mobile (third-party)	No magic length. ~800–2,000 characters covers hook, summary, bullets and chapters.	**3**. YouTube shows up to 3 above the title; over 60 means all are ignored.	HIGH rules · MEDIUM length
YouTube tags field	500 characters, commas included	n/a	A few misspellings and brand variants only	n/a	HIGH
LinkedIn post	3,000 characters (official)	~210 desktop, ~140 mobile (vendor-observed)	900–1,500 for reach; 1,500–2,500 when the goal is comments	**1–2** (max 3). 3+ is linked to lower reach.	HIGH limit · MEDIUM optimum
LinkedIn comment	1,250 characters (vendor test, Mar 2026)	n/a	Put the YouTube link here, not in the post body	n/a	MEDIUM
Instagram caption	2,200 characters incl. hashtags (official)	~125 feed, ~55–60 Reels (convention)	Reels 125–500 · carousels under 30 words · single images 300–800	**3–5. Hard cap 5 since 18 Dec 2025.**	HIGH cap · LOW–MED length
Instagram bio / name	150 / 30 characters	n/a	Put the main topic in the name field (it's searched)	n/a	MEDIUM–HIGH

Five findings that change what we do

1. Instagram now allows only 5 hashtags per post or Reel, down from 30. @creators announced it on 18 Dec 2025. Instagram says hashtags help label content but don't increase reach. HIGH

2. LinkedIn's "3–5 hashtags" house rule is contradicted by 2026 data. In two large median-based studies (566,957 and 516,144 posts), 0–2 hashtags were neutral and 3+ went with lower reach and fewer likes. Recommendation: **1–2, max 3**. MEDIUM

3. YouTube only ever shows 3 hashtags, so a 4th or 5th adds nothing visible. Recommendation: **3** (house rule currently 3–5). HIGH

4. A link in the body of a LinkedIn post goes with lower reach (−19% to −36% across three studies). For video promos, upload a native cut and put the YouTube link in the first comment. MEDIUM

5. The YouTube description doesn't decide the click; the title and thumbnail do. Across 150 videos from Nick Saraev, Riley Brown and Sabri Suby, no description feature consistently separated hits from misses. One rule did hold: **never open with a sponsor or third-party link**; your own CTA on line 1 is fine. MEDIUM

02 · YOUTUBE

YouTube descriptions

The description's job is to convert and help: line-1 CTA, a keyword-led hook, chapters and the offer. The research says it doesn't drive the click, so keep it clean, accurate and on brand.

Hard limits and rules

Item	Limit or rule	Source	Conf.
Title	**100 characters**; < and > not allowed	Official: YouTube Help 57404; Data API	HIGH
Title truncation	~60–70 characters on desktop search, ~40–60 on mobile. It's measured in pixels, not characters.	Third-party estimates	LOW
Description	**5,000 characters** (Help Centre). The API says **5,000 bytes**, and emojis and curly quotes cost 3–4 bytes each, so budget in bytes.	Official: Help 57404, 12948449; Data API	HIGH
Above "...more"	Officially "the first few lines". Third-party: ~157 characters desktop, ~100–150 mobile.	Official (no number); third-party	LOW (numbers)
Hashtags	YouTube shows **up to 3** "most engaging" hashtags by the title. **Over 60, all are ignored**. Over-tagging can get a video removed from search. Each hashtag must relate to the video, with no spaces.	Official: Help 6390658	HIGH
Tags field	**500 characters**. Commas count; a tag with a space counts +2. Tags "play a minimal role". Excessive tags in the description breach the spam policy.	Official: Data API; Help 146402	HIGH
Chapters	First at **0:00**, **at least 3**, ascending, each **at least 10 seconds**	Official: Help 9884579	HIGH
Comments / pinned comment	10,000 characters	Third-party	LOW-MED
Shorts	Links in Shorts descriptions and comments have **not been clickable since 31 Aug 2023**. No Shorts-specific text limits found.	Third-party news quoting YouTube	MEDIUM
Misleading metadata	Banned as "malicious clickbait" (titles, thumbnails or descriptions that misrepresent the video)	Official: Help 2801973	HIGH

What the creator data shows (150 videos)

Nick Saraev, Riley Brown and Sabri Suby, latest 30 + all-time top 20 each, from the Thumbnail Tracker data (12 Oct 2026). The outlier score is a video's views ÷ the median views of the 10 uploads either side of it.

Creator (latest 30)	Median length	Line 1	First link	Hashtags	Chapters
Nick Saraev	~3,500 characters	CTA in 30/30	line 1	0/30	24/30
Riley Brown	~950 characters	hook or keyword sentence	line 3	7/30 (mostly partner tags)	29/30
Sabri Suby	~310 characters	summary	line 3	0/30	0/30

- **All three styles produce hits** (~300, ~1,000 and ~3,500 characters), so no length is required. HIGH
- **No description feature consistently separates hits from misses.** Length, keyword placement, links and chapters each flip direction between creators and samples. MEDIUM
- **Sponsor-first descriptions sit on Riley's weak videos:** a CTA on line 1 scored 0.21× vs 1.12× (n = 4 vs 26), and a later first link went with higher scores (rho +0.39, n = 24). His own-product line-1 links in the all-time top 20 are neutral (7.54× vs 7.57×). Never open with a sponsor link; your own CTA is fine. MEDIUM
- **Hashtags are near-absent** (7 of 90 latest videos). **Chapters are a channel habit, not a lever.** HIGH (usage)
- This data confirms Thumbnail Tracker's description findings 17, 18 and 20 (description doesn't decide the click; chapters are a habit; hashtags barely used). Finding 19 (disclosure) wasn't re-tested.

Optimal YouTube description

Element	Recommendation	Conf.
Length	No target; ~800–2,000 characters. Enough for hook, summary, bullets and chapters. Never pad. Stay under 5,000 **bytes**.	MEDIUM
Line 1	Your own CTA (house rule: the WhatsApp line). Never a sponsor or third-party link.	MEDIUM
Line 2 (hook)	The WhatsApp line takes 108 characters, so the hook must **open with the title's searchable noun in its first ~40 characters**. That keeps the keyword inside the first ~150 characters.	MEDIUM
Chapters	On every long-form video: real timestamps, plain keyword names	HIGH
Hashtags	**3**: one topic, one audience, one series (#WhiteboardWednesdays). *House rule says 3–5; research says only 3 ever show.*	HIGH
Disclosure	For any affiliate, referral or sponsor link. A legal requirement in the UK and US.	HIGH
Pinned comment	Repeat the CTA, short	LOW
Shorts	Don't rely on description links; point to the long-form video or the channel links	MEDIUM

Where to research YouTube keywords and hashtags

Source	What it gives	Cost	Use it for
YouTube Studio → Analytics → Research tab	Searches across YouTube from the last 28 days (low/medium/high), "Your viewers' searches", content gaps. English searches from the UK, US, India, Australia and Canada.	Free	The best free source. Check every topic noun here.
YouTube search autocomplete	Real queries as you type (no volumes). Use a private window; the a–z trick widens the list.	Free	Phrasing of the title noun
Google Trends (set to **YouTube Search**)	Relative interest over time and by region, up to 5 terms	Free	Choosing between 2–3 phrasings
Google Ads Keyword Planner	Web search volumes (not YouTube volumes)	Free with an Ads account	A secondary check
vidIQ / TubeBuddy	Modelled volume and competition estimates	Freemium / paid	Optional; their volumes are estimates
Studio Inspiration tab	AI ideas. **Being phased out from Aug 2026** in favour of Ask Studio.	Free	Don't build on it
A hashtag's own results page	Whether the tag has related videos on it	Free	Vetting each of the 3 hashtags

10-minute workflow per video:

1. Run autocomplete on the topic noun.
2. Check the Research tab (popularity, content gap).
3. Compare 2–3 phrasings in Google Trends (YouTube Search; UK and worldwide; past 12 months).
4. Put the winner in the first 50 characters of the title and the first 40 of the hook.
5. Pick 3 hashtags (topic, audience, series) and vet each one's results page.

03 · LINKEDIN

LinkedIn posts and hashtags

The hook has to land in the first ~140 characters. Keep the post body free of links. Use one or two hashtags at most. Upload video natively, not as a YouTube link.

Hard limits

Item	Limit	Source	Conf.
Post (personal and company Page)	**3,000 characters**. LinkedIn may also limit how often you post (no number given).	Official: Help a528176	HIGH
"…see more" fold	**~210 characters desktop, ~140 mobile**; fewer when media is attached or there are line breaks	Vendor-observed; never published by LinkedIn	MEDIUM
Comment	1,250 characters (older sources say 1,750)	AuthoredUp test, Mar 2026	MEDIUM
Article	125,000 characters. SEO title under 60 characters; SEO description 140–160.	Official: a522483, a6244140	HIGH
Document (PDF carousel)	100 MB, 300 pages, one per post	Official: a518909	HIGH
Native video	Up to 5 GB, **15 minutes** (assume 10 from a phone until checked). Aspect ratio 1:2.4–2.4:1. Page videos 10 minutes.	Official: a548372, a1311816	HIGH
Poll	Question 140 characters; 2–4 options of 30 characters	Official: a527270	MED–HIGH
Headline / About	220 / 2,600 characters	Third-party	MEDIUM
Hashtags / mentions per post	No published limit. LinkedIn's feed lead: "don't go overboard".	Official advice, no number	MEDIUM

Hashtag research: what's changed and what works

- **The hashtag feed is going.** In July 2025 Rishi Jobanputra (LinkedIn's Feed product lead) said "people were not really using it… we are actually in the process of getting rid of it". He said hashtags still help "when people are trying to search for a specific trend or topic", and advised "don't go overboard". HIGH
- **Following hashtags was removed in 2024**, along with creator mode and "Talks about" profile hashtags. LinkedIn's old hashtag help page now returns 404. MED–HIGH
- **Reach falls as hashtags rise. Magicpost** (566,957 posts, median impressions): 0 → 874 · 1 → 847 · 2 → 825 · 3 → 637 · 5 → 492. **LinkPost** (516,144 posts, median likes): 1 hashtag +21%, 4–6 hashtags −40%. Hashtag use fell from 67.9% of posts (2022) to 23.2% (2026). MEDIUM
- **One outlier:** Metricool (673,658 posts) claims an 85% impressions lift with hashtags, but doesn't define what it compared against. LOW

> **Recommendation: 1–2 hashtags, max 3; zero is fine.** Put them at the end, on their own line, never in the hook. **This contradicts the current Pecuna house rule of 3–5.** Taylor to decide; we recommend updating it. (Placement is editorial advice; no study measures it.)

Where to research LinkedIn hashtags and trending topics

Source	What it gives	Cost
LinkedIn search → Posts filter → sort by Latest, searching `#tag` or a keyword	Real, recent use of the tag; who posts with it and what engagement they get. With follower counts gone, this is the main check.	Free
LinkedIn News / Top stories	Topics LinkedIn's editors are featuring now (topics, not tags). Good for timing an angle.	Free

Source	What it gives	Cost
Peer and competitor posts	The tags AI and agency peers actually use, and whether those posts perform. Check ~10 peers per pillar by hand; no scraping.	Free
Sales Navigator	What buyers (agency owners) post about; alerts on saved leads. Not a hashtag tool.	Paid
Taplio · AuthoredUp	Post inspiration, fold preview, analytics on your own posts' hashtags	Paid (Taplio from $39/month; AuthoredUp ~$20/month, unverified)
RiteTag · Shield	RiteTag's LinkedIn data source isn't disclosed. Shield may no longer operate.	Use with caution

Starter hashtag candidates for Pecuna (verify before use)

Pick **1–2 per post**: one broad, one niche. Check each in LinkedIn search (Posts, Latest) first.

Pillar	Broad	Niche candidates
AI agents / Claude Code / Codex	`#AI`	`#ClaudeCode` `#AIAgents` `#Anthropic` `#GenerativeAI` `#Automation`
Meta ads & paid social	`#DigitalMarketing`	`#MetaAds` `#FacebookAds` `#PaidSocial` `#PerformanceMarketing`
Agency growth & operations	`#AgencyGrowth`	`#AgencyOwner` `#MarketingAgency` `#AgencyLife`
ICP / buyer research	`#B2BMarketing`	`#CustomerResearch` `#BuyerPersona` `#Positioning`
Content & YouTube	`#ContentMarketing`	`#VideoMarketing` `#ContentStrategy` `#WhiteboardWednesdays` (series tag)

Post performance (2024–2026 studies)

Question	Finding	Evidence	Conf.
Length	Reach peaks at ~150–174 words (~900–1,050 characters). Engagement and comments keep rising with longer posts (1,500–2,500+).	Shield Index (167,940 posts); Ordinal (248,275); LinkPost (516,144)	MEDIUM
Hook	80% of highly viral posts had a strong hook in the first 200 characters; 61% had a data point. LinkedIn's own ranking penalises posts people scroll straight past (its "skip" model, 2020).	LinkPost top-1% (438,413); LinkedIn Engineering 2020	MEDIUM
Links in the post body	Lower reach: −36% (LinkPost), −26.5% (Ordinal, mostly company pages), −18.8% (van der Blom). LinkedIn has never confirmed a penalty. Link-in-first-comment tests are tiny (4–6 posts per arm).	Three vendor studies	MEDIUM
Formats	Document carousels had the top engagement rate (7.00%, company pages). Video and carousels lead on likes; text-only is lowest. Video reach on personal profiles fell 36% year on year.	Socialinsider (1.3M posts); LinkPost; AuthoredUp	MEDIUM
Frequency	2–5 posts a week beats 1 (+1,182 impressions per post), and the gains continue at higher frequencies.	Buffer (2M+ posts, 94k accounts, within-account comparison)	MED–HIGH
What LinkedIn demotes (Mar 2026)	"Comment to agree" bait, engagement pods, comment automation, "videos that don't match the text"	Official: LinkedIn News	HIGH

Optimal LinkedIn post (against the house rule)

Lever	Recommendation	Against the house rule
Max	3,000 characters	Confirmed
Length	900–1,500 for reach; 1,500–2,500 for teaching or opinion posts aimed at comments	Mostly confirmed; the data also supports going longer

Lever	Recommendation	Against the house rule
Hook	The whole hook inside ~140 characters, ideally one line of ≤110, with a number or a contrarian claim	Confirmed
Hashtags	**1–2, max 3**, at the end on their own line	**Contradicted (was 3–5)**
Video promo	Upload a **30–90 s native cut**, captioned, with text that matches the video. Put the YouTube link in the first comment. Alternative: a document carousel of the whiteboard frames.	New
CTA	A specific question that invites a real reply. No bait, pods or automation. Reply to comments by hand.	New

04 · INSTAGRAM

Instagram captions and hashtags

Up to five hashtags, chosen for relevance rather than reach. Put the hook and keyword in the first line, keep captions short on carousels, and give one clear CTA.

Hard limits (date-stamped)

Item	Limit	Source	Conf.
Hashtags per post or Reel	**5** (was 30). "Starting today, Instagram will allow up to 5 hashtags in a reel or post." Rolled out from **18 Dec 2025**.	Official: @creators on Threads; Social Media Today	HIGH
Caption	**2,200 characters**, hashtags and links included	Official: Meta API reference	HIGH
Caption fold	~125 characters in feed; ~55–60 on the Reels overlay	Convention; Meta doesn't publish one	MEDIUM / LOW
@mentions	20 per caption	Official: API	HIGH
Carousel	20 slides (since Aug 2024); one caption per post	Official: API	HIGH
Alt text	Up to 1,000 characters per image; not for Reels or Stories	Official: API	HIGH
Reels length	API publishing 3 s–15 min. In-app camera up to 20 min (reported Nov 2025). ≤3 min reportedly needed to reach non-followers.	Official (API); third-party	MEDIUM
Bio / name / username	150 / 30 / 30 characters. The name field is searchable.	Third-party	MED-HIGH
Comment-to-DM automation	One automated private reply per comment, within 7 days	Official: Meta Private Replies docs	HIGH
Following hashtags	Removed 13 Dec 2024 (you can still tag and search)	Third-party	HIGH
Reels text safe zone	No official organic spec. Convention: ~220 px top, ~420 px bottom of 1080×1920. Meta's ads guidance: 14% top, 35% bottom.	Convention; Meta ads guidance	MEDIUM

Hashtag research

- **Instagram's official position:** hashtags are a **labelling and search aid, not a reach lever**. Instagram's guidance with the cap: "using fewer (up to 5) more targeted hashtags, rather than many generic ones, can improve both your content's performance and people's experience". Avoid #reels, #explore, #viral, #fyp. HIGH
- **Search is keyword-led.** Account search matches username and display name (Meta Transparency Centre, Jun 2026). Mosseri says search also reads captions, comments and the video itself (Jul 2026, reported). Google can index public professional posts (since Jul 2025). MEDIUM
- **Correlation in the largest study:** posts with at least 1 hashtag had 31.7% fewer views and 33.9% fewer interactions than average (Metricool, 24.4M posts, Jun 2026). This doesn't show hashtags cause the drop, but they clearly don't help reach. MEDIUM
- **Hashtags in the first comment:** unclear under the 5-tag cap; sources conflict. **Put them in the caption.** MEDIUM
- **Checking for banned tags:** open the tag's page in the app. No results, or "recent posts hidden", means restricted. Check Settings → Account Status to see whether you can appear in Search.

> **Recommendation: 3–5 hashtags, at the end of the caption.** Mix: **1 branded + 1 broad + 1–3 niche**, chosen by relevance, not post count. Put 1–2 search phrases naturally in line 1 and the body, repeat the key phrase in on-screen text, and add the topic to the display name (e.g. "Taylor, AI for Agencies").

Where to find trending and relevant Instagram hashtags

Source	What it gives	Cost	Reliability
In-app search (Tags and keyword results)	Autocomplete, ranked by query similarity and by how often people searching the same thing in your country click each suggestion (official). Post counts shown inconsistently; check live.	Free	High

Source	What it gives	Cost	Reliability
Professional Dashboard → Reels Trends	Trending audio and trending hashtags for Reels (professional accounts; may be region-limited)	Free	Medium
Hashtag pages	Top-posts grid. Whether post counts still show (Oct 2026) is unverified.	Free	Medium
Post Insights	Which surface brought reach (Home, Explore, Reels, Profile). A separate "from hashtags" line isn't confirmed as still present.	Free	Low (for hashtags)
Meta Business Suite / Graph API hashtag search	Top and recent media for a tag; 30 unique tags per 7 days	Free (API needs review)	High
Competitor and peer posts	Tags AI and agency creators actually use	Free	Medium
Flick · Later · Metricool	Hashtag search, banned-tag audit, tracking (Flick from ~£11/month, no free plan)	Paid / freemium	Medium
Inflact · RiteTag · Display Purposes	Generators; current Instagram data access unverified since Dec 2024	Mixed	Low; ideas only

Starter hashtag sets for Pecuna (candidates; check post counts and restrictions in the app)

Pillar	Branded (1)	Broad (1)	Niche (pick 1–3)
AI agents / Claude Code / Codex	`#WhiteboardWednesdays`	`#AI`	`#ClaudeCode` `#ClaudeAI` `#AIAgents` `#AIAutomation` `#AIForBusiness`
Meta ads	`#PecunaFactorem`	`#DigitalMarketing`	`#MetaAds` `#FacebookAds` `#PaidSocial` `#AdStrategy`
Agency growth	`#WhiteboardWednesdays`	`#MarketingAgency`	`#AgencyOwner` `#AgencyGrowth` `#UKBusiness`
ICP research	`#PecunaFactorem`	`#Marketing`	`#IdealCustomerProfile` `#CustomerResearch` `#B2BMarketing`
Content creation	`#WhiteboardWednesdays`	`#ContentMarketing`	`#ContentStrategy` `#VideoMarketing` `#CreatorEconomy`

Excluded on purpose: #ICP (also a cryptocurrency). Check #Codex before use; it's also a common word and other brands use it.

Caption performance and the optimal caption

Element	Recommendation	Evidence	Conf.
Reels caption	125–500 characters: hook line, 1–3 short lines of value, then the CTA. The video carries the message.	Socialinsider × Sked (video: 30+ words better); PostPlanify (6,126 posts)	LOW–MED
Carousel caption	Under ~30 words (~150–200 characters) + CTA; the slides carry the content	Socialinsider (9.1M posts, 2023 data)	MEDIUM
Single image	300–800 characters, story-led, with line breaks	PostPlanify (small)	LOW
First line	≤125 characters (≤60 for Reels), with the outcome and main keyword	Fold convention; search reads captions	MEDIUM
CTA (one per post)	A question (+36.7% comments); a comment-focused CTA (+202.8% comments); "Comment WORD and I'll DM you the template" (Private Replies); "Send this to your media buyer" (sends, a top ranking signal); "Link in bio"	Metricool 2026 (24.4M posts); Mosseri on sends	MEDIUM
Alt text	Custom on every image and slide, ≤~125 characters	Meta API; accessibility guidance	HIGH feature
Emoji / line breaks	0–3 functional emoji; short paragraphs	No large study	LOW
Frequency	3–5 posts a week (+~12% reach per post vs 1–2)	Buffer (2M+ posts)	HIGH

05 · WHAT WE LIFT

The good parts of Thumbnail Tracker

Performance Poster reuses what's already proven in Thumbnail Tracker (3.3.1). It copies; it doesn't edit. Thumbnail Tracker keeps thumbnails and titles, unchanged.

Lifted part	What it is	How Performance Poster uses it
Research method	Latest 30 + all-time top 20 per creator; outlier ratio = views ÷ median of the 10 uploads either side; era and channel-size confounds; n and confidence on every claim	The same method for Instagram and LinkedIn once logged-in data is available
Description findings 17–20	The description doesn't decide the click; chapters are a habit; disclose links; hashtags barely used on YouTube	Re-tested in Section 2 (17, 18 and 20 confirmed). They become the YouTube section's foundation.
Description framework	9 parts in order: CTA line → hook → summary → What you'll learn → chapters → How we can help → links → disclosure → hashtags; plus Sabri, Nick and Riley styles	The YouTube output structure (Section 6)
House style	The WhatsApp CTA verbatim on line 1 (space after 👉); a blank line between every bullet, chapter and paragraph; UK English; no client names; real figures only; one copy-and-paste box	Applied to every output
CTA library	6 approved CTAs + PDF (01 pinned WhatsApp; 02 book a call; 03 how we can help; 04/05 LinkedIn; 06 skill build)	The CTA for each platform comes from here
Taylor's voice	9 headline patterns (I built…, AI as the actor, curiosity verdicts, two-beat lines, his own spoken lines)	Hooks and first lines in his voice
Headline log	Every headline written, picked or published, with CTR results (44 rows)	Hooks are logged the same way, so winners can be reused
Checker (`package.py`)	Title ≤70; chapters (0:00, ≥3, ≥10 s); disclosure; LinkedIn hook and length; hashtag count; placeholders	Grows into one checker covering every platform's limits (Section 6)
Worked examples	ICP Research (published description), AI Harnesses (10 scored titles, description), AI Vision Boards	The first examples and regression tests
Not lifted	The high-quality thumbnail renderer, layouts, fonts, logos, check sheet, feed mock	Stay in Thumbnail Tracker

Changes the research suggests to house rules (Taylor to decide)

House rule today	Research says	Suggested rule
YouTube: 3–5 hashtags	Only 3 are ever shown	**3**: topic, audience, #WhiteboardWednesdays
LinkedIn: 3–5 hashtags	3+ goes with lower reach (two studies, 1M+ posts)	**1–2**, max 3, at the end
LinkedIn: a link in the post	Body links go with −19% to −36% reach	Link in the first comment; native video cut in the post
Instagram: none yet	Cap of 5; relevance beats volume	3–5: 1 branded + 1 broad + 1–3 niche

06 · BUILD & USE

How Performance Poster will work

You give it a video topic and brief. It returns the full YouTube description (CTA included), the LinkedIn post and the Instagram caption with hashtags, each checked against the platform's limits.

Using it

1. **Give it the brief.** The minimum is the topic, the working or final title, the promise, the real proof said in the video, chapters with real timestamps and the content pillar. Optional: a transcript, links and best lines.
2. **Say "post this", or name a platform** ("just the YouTube description").
3. **Get back** one copy-and-paste box per platform, with character counts, the hashtags chosen (and why), and any `[PLACEHOLDER]` left to fill.
4. **Paste and publish.** After 48 hours, give it CTR, impressions or engagement, and it logs the result against the hook and hashtags.

The brief (template)

```
TITLE:        I Built an AI Harness So Claude Code Can Run for 24 Hours
PILLAR:       AI agents / Claude Code
PROMISE:      Use AI harnesses to manage more clients and run tasks for longer with fewer mistakes
AUDIENCE:     Agency owners and 1–3 person teams using Claude Code or Codex
PROOF (said): 2 hours, 20% → 80%, 24–36 hours, 58 problems, 11 parts, 9 steps, under an hour
CHAPTERS:     0:00 The bouncing ball … 29:43 Build your own   (real timestamps only)
BEST LINES:   "It's actually a liability because it's cost you tokens."
LINKS:        contact https://pecunafactorem.com/contact · booking [BOOKING LINK]
PLATFORMS:    YouTube, LinkedIn (native cut + carousel), Instagram (Reel)
```

What it generates

YouTube description: the full framework, in order

#	Part	Rule
1	**CTA line**	Exactly: "Want to chat? Give me a message on WhatsApp. This is my personal number 👉 https://pecunafactorem.com/contact", then a blank line (108 characters)
2	**Hook**	Opens with the title's searchable noun in the first ~40 characters (it must land inside the first ~150 overall); the promise and one real proof detail
3	Summary	2–3 sentences: why it matters now, what the video walks through. Always written fresh for this video.
4	Offer line	CTA 02 "Want this built for your agency? Book a call:" plus the booking link, or the contact link if there's no booking link
5	What you'll learn	3–10 bullets of real specifics from the video, a blank line between each
6	Chapters	0:00 first, ≥3, ascending, ≥10 s apart, real timestamps, plain keyword names, a blank line between each
7	How we can help	CTA 03 adapted to the video, then the contact link on its own line
8	Links	"Pecuna Factorem: https://pecunafactorem.com"; never invented
9	Disclosure	Only if there's an affiliate, referral or sponsor link
10	Hashtags	3: topic, audience, #WhiteboardWednesdays

LinkedIn post

A hook of ≤110 characters (inside the ~140 mobile fold), in Taylor's voice → a short story or teaching body of 900–1,500 characters (up to 2,500 for teaching) → one specific question → 1–2 hashtags on their own line. Format: a native 30–90 s cut, with the YouTube link in the first comment, or a document carousel of the whiteboard frames. No bait such as "comment to agree".

Instagram caption

A first line of ≤60 characters for Reels or ≤125 for feed, with the outcome and keyword → a body of 125–500 characters for Reels, or under 30 words for carousels → one CTA (comment WORD for a DM, send to a colleague, or link in bio) → 3–5 hashtags (1 branded, 1 broad, 1–3 niche) at the end → alt text per slide. It also suggests a display-name keyword and on-screen text for Reels.

The checker (every output, before delivery)

Check	YouTube	LinkedIn	Instagram
Hard maximum	Title ≤100 (brand ≤70); description ≤5,000 bytes; tags ≤500	≤3,000	≤2,200 including hashtags
Above the fold	CTA line exact; keyword within the first 150 characters	Hook ≤140 (warn over 110)	First line ≤125 (≤60 for Reels)
Hashtags	Exactly 3 (error over 60)	0–3 (warn over 2)	≤5 (error over 5)
Structure	Chapters 0:00 / ≥3 / ≥10 s; blank-line spacing; disclosure if affiliate links	No link in the body (warn); no bait phrases	One CTA; alt text present for images
Truth	Figures must appear in the brief's PROOF list; no client names; no leftover placeholders unless flagged		

Building the skill

```
performance-poster/
  SKILL.md                    router: YouTube description · LinkedIn post · Instagram caption · hashtags ·
"post everything"
  references/
    limits.md / limits.json   every limit in this report, with source URL + date checked
    youtube.md                description framework + findings (Section 2)
    linkedin.md               post + hashtag rules (Section 3)
    instagram.md              caption + hashtag rules (Section 4)
    hashtags/pecuna.md        verified tag sets per pillar, refreshed monthly
    brief-template.md         the brief above
  shared/ (copied from Thumbnail Tracker, not edited there)
    house-style.md · cta-library.md · taylor-voice.md · headline-log.csv
  scripts/
    check_post.py             the checker above, reading limits.json
    hashtag_log.py            logs tags used + results per post
  examples/  ai-harnesses/ · icp-research/   (inputs + approved outputs)
  tests/     limits, spacing, hashtag caps, examples pass the checker
```

1. **Freeze the limits** from this report into `limits.json`, with a "re-check by" date 90 days out.
2. **Copy the shared brand files** from Thumbnail Tracker. Apply the house-rule changes Taylor approves.
3. **Write the three platform references** from Sections 2–4.
4. **Build `check_post.py`** with tests: every number in the checker table is a test case.
5. **Verify the starter hashtags live** (Instagram app and LinkedIn search), and save the verified sets.
6. **Run the AI Harnesses and ICP briefs** through the skill as examples; Taylor approves the outputs.
7. **Package the skill as a zip** and upload it to claude.ai.

> **Next research step (needs Taylor's logged-in access):** collect the last 30 posts each from Nick Saraev, Sabri Suby, Riley Brown, Jeremy Haynes, Alex Finn and Daniel Priestley on Instagram and LinkedIn, via Claude in Chrome or screenshots. Then measure their caption length, first line, CTA and hashtags the same way as the YouTube study.

07 · SOURCES

Sources, confidence and gaps

All sources accessed 20 October 2026. The full research notes, the analysis script and per-video data sit beside this PDF in the repo.

YouTube (official)

support.google.com/youtube/answer/57404 · /answer/12948449 · /answer/6390658 · /answer/9884579 · /answer/146402 · /answer/2801973 · /answer/11962757 · /answer/15575509 · developers.google.com/youtube/v3/docs/videos

YouTube (third-party)

tubefilter.com (Shorts links, Aug 2023) · searchenginejournal.com · malwarebytes.com · link.boo · socialk.it · unilink.us · advancedcharactercounter.com · collabpals.com · creaticalc.com · howmanywords.app · influencermarketinghub.com · typecount.com · vidiq.com · ppc.land · Thumbnail Tracker research data (150 videos, 12 Oct 2026)

LinkedIn (official)

linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a528176 · a522483 · a518909 · a523054 · a548372 · a1311816 · a527270 · a522948 · a6244140 · a528144 (404) · news.linkedin.com/2026/ImprovingTheFeed · LinkedIn Engineering "Understanding feed dwell time" (2020) · Rishi Jobanputra post (Jul 2025, via digitalinformationworld.com)

LinkedIn (third-party studies)

Buffer (2M+ posts) · Socialinsider 2025/2026 benchmarks (1.3M posts) · Ordinal (248,275 posts; link study) · Shield Index (167,940 posts) · LinkPost (516,144 posts) · Magicpost (566,957 posts) · Metricool (673,658 posts) · Richard van der Blom via agilitypr.com · Sprout Social and Agorapulse first-comment tests · AuthoredUp · Social Media Today (creator mode) · contentin.io · linkedgrow.ai · taplio.com · ritekit.com

Instagram (official)

@creators Threads post DSaIXGPCWM4 (18 Dec 2025) · developers.facebook.com Instagram Platform: IG User Media, Private Replies, Hashtag Search · transparency.meta.com IG Search · about.instagram.com "Instagram ranking explained" (2023) · help.instagram.com alt text

Instagram (third-party)

Social Media Today and Social Samosa (5-tag cap) · Metricool 2026 Instagram Study (24.4M posts) and limits guide · Socialinsider caption study (9.1M posts) and 2026 benchmarks · PostPlanify (6,126 posts) · Sked × Socialinsider · Hootsuite experiments · Buffer frequency and Reels length · Kontentino (Mosseri, Jul 2026) · Lindsey Gamble · PetaPixel · TechRadar · TechCrunch · Inro · Ignite · Bundle.social · Izea · Search Engine Journal · Adweek · Flick review

What we couldn't verify

Platform	Gap	How to close it
All	Exact "…more" / "see more" fold lengths. No platform publishes them.	Paste test text in each composer and record the cut
YouTube	Raw descriptions for all 150 videos; the 3 watchlist creators (YouTube blocked the fetch on the day); whether title hashtags displace description hashtags	Re-run the fetch from a logged-in machine; one test upload
LinkedIn	Any official link-penalty statement; the mentions cap; 10 vs 15 minutes for mobile video; current posts from the 6 creators (n = 3 old posts only)	Logged-in collection via Claude in Chrome
Instagram	Help Centre wording for the 5-tag cap; whether comments and the API are capped at 5; links in bio (1/3/5); comment length; whether hashtag post counts and "reach from hashtags" still show; the 6 creators' captions (n = 0)	Check in the app; logged-in collection
All	No CTR, search-traffic or link-click data, so every performance finding is observational	Log Pecuna's own results at 48 hours and 30 days (headline and hashtag logs)

Fonts: Fraunces, Instrument Sans and IBM Plex Mono, bundled under their licences in `fonts/`. Built from `performance-poster-research.html` with Playwright.